



## Esther \*ET\* Franklin

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***Esther is a transformative, multi-sector business executive who architects growth at the intersection of brand/marketing/healthcare strategy, audience intelligence and AI-powered innovation - delivering measurable outcomes for some of the world's most recognized brands. A trusted C-Suite advisor and organizational builder who has led CEO transition, she brings the strategic foresight and digital fluency to lead brands - and the teams behind them - through the complexities of an AI-powered world.***

**Expertise.** Scales global organizations driving shareholder value and business transformation; (*Enterprise Growth & Organizational Scale*). Engineers strategies deepening customer relationships and connecting brand investment to measurable growth; (*Audience-First Strategies*). Applies generative AI to audience intelligence and marketing innovation; (*AI & Generative Technology Integration*). Repositions iconic brands by connecting strategy to business results; (*Brand & Marketing Strategy*). Guides senior leaders through AI-driven transformation & evolving ways of working - across consumer and healthcare sectors - fostering high-performing environments where all talent can thrive; (*C-Suite Advisory & Executive Leadership*). Wins and expands client relationships across retail, CPG, financial services, healthcare, QSR, insurance & entertainment globally; (*New Business Development*).

**Recognition.** 3x Cannes Lions Judge, *Crain's Chicago Business* - Notable Nonprofit Board Leader (2024).

**Transformative Growth.** As Chief Strategy Officer at Publicis Media (PM) - a division of Publicis Groupe, one of the world's largest marketing and communications conglomerates - Esther drives transformative growth and organizational scale. A pivotal leader on the executive team and a direct report to the Global CEO of Spark Foundry - the flagship brand inside PM - she was central in architecting its global expansion while building a culture fit for global enterprise. The organization scaled from 160 to 3,000+ diverse employees across 50 countries during her tenure, elevating it to a large-cap, global enterprise generating significant shareholder value through early adoption of AI-powered business models and generative technology integration.

**Audience Strategy as Competitive Advantage - From Retention to New Revenue.** Esther pioneers' audience-first marketing strategies helping brands deepen relationships with existing customers while identifying new ones for growth. Combining brand/category/consumer/health data powered by generative AI, her leadership drives teams to pinpoint high-value audience segments and identify outcomes each must deliver against business goals. Her approach yields actionable audience insights; the foundation brands leverage to calibrate an intentional mix of precise targeting and relevant content meeting customers where they are across social/e-commerce/traditional media platforms. As a result, brands can engage customers across their full lifecycle driving loyalty & long-term growth. This method unlocks growth for Fortune 500 brands including Citibank, Comcast, KFC, NVI (National Vision, Inc.), Marriott, Mattel, Vanguard & Publicis Health Media (PHM). It also secured major new business wins and expanded scope across retail, CPG, financial services, QSR, insurance and entertainment sectors globally.

**Leading the Future: Outcomes Focused Executive in the Age of Intelligent Organizations.** Esther knows what it takes to build leaders and inclusive organizations for an AI-powered world. After leading the largest practice area of Spark Foundry, 400+ media strategists and planners, she is now actively guiding C-Suite teams through that transition. She combines digital/cultural fluency and human depth to design marketing and brand strategies that meet the moment - engineering new ways of working that fuel cross-functional collaboration, elevate talent, and deliver innovative solutions through evolving, data-driven approaches. Through this foresight, Esther has led AI-powered digital transformation, brand and marketing repositioning initiatives for Global Disney Parks, Starbucks, Macy's, and Kimberly-Clark - creating strategic frameworks that connect brand investments to prioritized audiences and measurable, business outcomes.

**Boards/Recognition/Organizations.** BOARDS: Chicago Urban League - *Secretary*, The Family Institute at Northwestern University - *Chair*, Lurie Children's Hospital - *Advisory Board*, WARC Rankings - *Advisory Board*. RECOGNITION: Advertising Woman of the Year - *Chicago Advertising Federation*, Advertising Legend - *ADCOLOR*. MEMBER: Northwestern University Council of 100, Private Directors Association, The Arts Club of Chicago, The Chicago Network (TCN), The Economic Club of Chicago.

**Esther received her M.M. from Northwestern University** - Kellogg School of Management. And her B.S. in Business Administration from the University of Illinois - Urbana/Champaign.